

composers such as Arnold Schoenberg and, especially, the harmonies and rhythms of jazz (see box).



RAVEL'S PIANO

Ravel's piano is on display in the small house in which he lived (now the Musée Maurice Ravel), in Montfort-l'Amaury, for the last 20 years of his life.

Final years

The change in musical style was accompanied by a change in lifestyle. Ravel's wartime experiences had aged him, and he found living in Paris overbearing, so he moved to Montfort-l'Amaury, west of Paris, where he lived alone for the rest of his life. Although Ravel is thought to have had one or two long-term relationships, he never married and by some accounts visited brothels from time to time. At Montfort-l'Amaury he produced, some of his finest and best-known music, concluding with *Boléro* and the two piano concertos.

Ravel's final years were marred by illness. In 1932, he suffered